

Abby Buchanan

UX Researcher & Strategist

Portfolio: Abby Buchanan — UX Research & Systems Strategy ↗

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SUMMARY

UX researcher and strategist focused on how people experience systems under real-world conditions—cognitively, emotionally, and environmentally.

I study moments where people get stuck—overwhelm, ambiguity, and breakdown in task initiation—and translate behavioral insight into clearer, more usable systems. My practice builds on decades of client-centered inquiry, structured interviewing, behavioral observation, and systems-oriented design across physical, digital, and organizational environments. I'm especially interested in qualitative research, accessibility, human-centered AI adoption, and interdisciplinary work where research can help shape the response.

CORE SKILLS

Qualitative Research • User Interviews • Usability Testing • Research Synthesis • Research Strategy • Systems Thinking • Information Architecture • Journey Mapping • Accessibility • Neurodivergent Design • Cross-functional Collaboration

Tools: Figma • FigJam • Miro • Notion • Google Workspace • Agile Environments

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Education & curriculum design for international ExxonMobil executives, adapting instruction across professional, cultural, and learning contexts.

EXPERIENCE

Studio Manager (UX Systems & Operations) Amri Studio | 2022–2024

- Redesigned physical, operational, and information-flow systems within a complex studio environment, improving clarity, team alignment, accessibility, and workflow
- Improved usability and accessibility of the physical workspace, supporting neurodivergent employees

Freelance UX & Spatial Designer
2019–Present

- Conducted user-informed design for neurodivergent individuals, incorporating therapist input and individualized needs
- Designed sensory-informed and biophilic environments supporting regulation, clarity, and cognitive ease
- Designed curriculum for a multi-age pod-based homeschool, structuring content to support clarity and cognitive pacing

Freelance Web Designer (UX-Focused)
2019–Present

- Designed websites with clear user flows, improving onboarding and booking experiences by translating client needs into structured digital systems
- Developed a structured client discovery framework combining analytical and intuitive inputs to translate abstract brand identity into clear, systemized design direction

Founder & Owner
Veda Collective | 2011–2019

- Scaled a solo practice into a team of 5 practitioners
- Designed end-to-end client experience, including intake, booking flows, and service structure
- Conducted client interviews and translated behavioral insights into repeatable, user-centered service delivery

Co-Owner & Systems Designer
Resound NW | 2019–Present

- Designed and iterated on studio environments across multiple locations
- Contributed to systems supporting students and instructors
- Supported operational and strategic decision-making

EDUCATION & TRAINING

Human–Computer Interaction (HCI), Cornell University (eCornell)
B.M. Music Composition (Tech Minor), Oral Roberts University
Psychology of Home Design — Psychologie of Home